

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

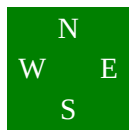
♠ J 9 7  
♥ Q 10 9 6  
♦ J 9  
♣ J 10 6 2

♠ A K 5 2

♥ A K 4 3

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 9 5



♠ Q 10 6 4  
♥ J 8 2  
♦ K 8 4  
♣ Q 8 3

♠ 8 3

♥ 7 5

♦ A Q 10 6 2

♣ A K 7 4

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1 ♦   |
| Pass         | 1 ♥   | Pass | 2 ♣   |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠ 4    |       |      |       |

time the finesse works, and even more happily both defenders follow suit. That means the rest of the ♦s are good and you make an overtrick.

This was just a normal suit-establishment Deal.

If looked different because of the two finesses you took.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠ 4.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need two more winners. They cannot possibly come from ♠s, ♥s, or ♣s since one defender must hold at least 4 cards in each of those suits. So your two extra winners must come from the ♦ suit.

There is no reason to hold up on the ♠ since the ♥ and ♣ suits also have just two stoppers. You win the ♠ A.

You best play next is to finesse the ♦ 10. This may gain a trick by virtue of the finesse if East happens to hold the ♦ J, but primarily you are working to establish the ♦ suit. Assume West wins the ♦ J and returns a ♠.

Again don't hold up. Take the ♠ K and lead another small ♦, finessing with dummy's ♦ Q. Happily this

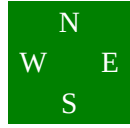
**Board 2**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 7  
 ♥ 4 3  
 ♦ 8 6 5 2  
 ♣ A 8 6 5 3

♠ A 8 5  
 ♥ Q 10 9 6  
 ♦ Q J 9  
 ♣ 10 7 4



♠ K Q 3  
 ♥ A 7 5 2  
 ♦ A K 4  
 ♣ Q J 9

♠ J 10 6 4 2  
 ♥ K J 8  
 ♦ 10 7 3  
 ♣ K 2

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| Pass        | Pass  | 1 ♣  | Pass  |
| 2 ♣         | Pass  | 3NT  |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3NT by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠ 4   |       |      |       |

you could establish the suit in dummy.

South's play of the ♣ K may have made you want to jump up with the ♣ A, but you must stick to the original play of ducking one trick.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠ 4. North puts on the ♠ A and returns the ♠ 8.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

Needing three more winners you are going to have to establish the ♣ suit. You are also going to have to be lucky!

You win the second ♠ and play your ♣ Q. South covers with the ♣ K. What do you do next?

You **DUCK**. If you take the ♣ A now you will never get back to dummy to enjoy those other ♣ s. So let South have the ♣ K. You win his return, (probably a ♠), and play ♣ J, then ♣ 9 to dummy's ♣ A. As long as ♣ s split 3-2 you will get the three winners you need.

You were prepared to lose that ♣ finesse to North so

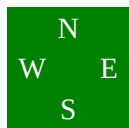
**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 8 2  
 ♥ K 10 4  
 ♦ 8 7 2  
 ♣ K J 7

♠ 7 5 4  
 ♥ A Q 8 7 5  
 ♦ 9 6 3  
 ♣ 8 4



♠ J 9 6  
 ♥ J 9 2  
 ♦ Q J 10  
 ♣ 10 9 3 2

♠ A Q 3  
 ♥ 6 3  
 ♦ A K 5 4  
 ♣ A Q 6 5

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | Pass  | Pass | 1 ♦   |
| Pass         | 1 ♥   | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠ 2    |       |      |       |

let you wind up with no tricks at all in the ♥ suit.

But, it is your only chance to make the contract.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠ 2. East puts on the ♠ J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need three more winners. It is possible your fourth ♦ can be established, but that needs a 3-3 split. It's also possible that the ♣ finesse will work, and also the ♥ finesse. Since you need the ♥ finesse anyway you should go ahead and try to establish the ♥s.

Win the first trick with your ♠Q and play a low ♥, ducking in dummy. East will no doubt win a cheap trick but no matter. When you next gain the lead play your other low ♥ and finesse the ♥Q. Assume this wins (if it doesn't you will be going down for sure). Play the ♥A and if both defenders follow your other 2 ♥s are good and your contract is made.

Ducking the first ♥ and finessing the second could

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

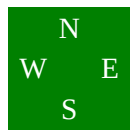
♠ 7 4  
 ♥ A Q 8 6 2  
 ♦ Q 6  
 ♣ A 8 4 3

♠ K Q J 10

♥ 10 9

♦ 7 4 3

♣ K 10 7 2



♠ 8 6 5 3

♥ K 5 4

♦ K J 10 8 5

♣ Q

♠ A 9 2

♥ J 7 3

♦ A 9 2

♣ J 9 6 5

West

1♥

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

Lead: ♠K

North

Pass

East

3♥

South

Pass

Some pretty aggressive bidding gets you to a challenging game. West is to play 4♥. North leads the ♠K, overtaken by South's ♠A. South returns a ♠ to North's ♠10, and he then plays the ♠Q.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 6

With 2 tricks already gone you still have 4 losers. You could consider ruffing the 3 ♣ losers in dummy but that would just create a trump loser even when trumps are splitting 3-2. So it looks like you will have to establish the ♦ suit for discards. You could pull trumps and then play your ♦Q, hoping the defenders will grab their ♦A immediately. But unless they are real novices they will hold it up one round and you'll no longer be able to reach dummy.

The solution is to establish the ♦s before you use up dummy's ♥K.

Ruff the third ♠, then play ♦Q, (which they will duck), and another ♦, (which they will probably take). Win whatever they return, pull trumps ending in dummy, and enjoy your 3 ♦ winners.

If South does not take the second ♦ you continue the suit, and whether you ruff or discard a loser you still make the contract.